

051. Chapter 4 Verses 20-22

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.20

त्यक्त्वा कर्मफलासङ्गं नित्यतृप्तो निराश्रयः ।
कर्मण्यभिप्रवृत्तोऽपि नैव किञ्चित्करोति सः ॥ 20 ॥

tyaktvā karma-phalāsaṅgaṁ nitya-trīpto nirāśrayaḥ
karmaṇyabhipravṛitto 'pi naiva kiñchit karoti saḥ

tyaktvā—having given up; **karma-phala-āsaṅgam**—attachment to the fruits of action; **nitya**—always; **trīptaḥ**—satisfied; **nirāśrayaḥ**—without dependence; **karmaṇi**—in activities; **abhipravṛittaḥ**—engaged; **api**—despite; **na**—not; **eva**—certainly; **kiñchit**—anything; **karoti**—do; **saḥ**—that person

He who has given up attachment to the fruits of work, who is ever content, who does not depend upon anything, though engaged in action does not verily do anything.

VERSE 4.21

निराशीर्यतचित्तात्मा त्यक्तसर्वपरिग्रहः ।
शारीरं केवलं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥ 21 ॥

nirāśhīr yata-chittātmā tyakta-sarva-parigrahaḥ
śhārīraṁ kevalaṁ karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣham

nirāśhīḥ—free from expectations; **yata**—controlled; **chitta-ātmā**—mind and intellect; **tyakta**—having abandoned; **sarva**—all; **parigrahaḥ**—the sense of ownership; **śhārīram**—bodily; **kevalam**—only; **karma**—actions; **kurvan**—performing; **na**—never; **āpnoti**—incurs; **kilbiṣham**—sin

He who is free from hope, who is self-controlled, who has abandoned all possessions, though working merely with the body, does not incur sin.

यदृच्छालाभसन्तुष्टो द्वन्द्वातीतो विमत्सरः ।
समः सिद्धावसिद्धौ च कृत्वापि न निबध्यते ॥ 22 ॥

*yadṛichchhā-lābha-santuṣṭo dvandvātīto vimatsaraḥ
samaḥ siddhāvasiddhau cha kṛtvāpi na nibadhyate*

yadṛichchhā—which comes of its own accord; **lābha**—gain; **santuṣṭaḥ**—contented; **dvandva**—duality; **atītaḥ**—surpassed; **vimatsaraḥ**—free from envy; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **siddhau**—in success; **asiddhau**—failure; **cha**—and; **kṛtvā**—performing; **api**—even; **na**—never; **nibadhyate**—is bound

Content with whatsoever he gets without efforts, free from the pairs of opposites, free from malice, balanced in success and failure, though acting, he is not bound.